

P-16**(PRE-BOARD1 EXAMINATION) 2024-25****CLASS: XII****SUBJECT: ENGLISH****Time Allowed: 3Hrs****Max Marks: 80****General Instructions:**

- 1. 15-minute prior reading time allotted for Q-paper reading.**
- 2. The Question Paper contains THREE sections-READING, WRITING and LITERATURE.**
- 3. Attempt questions based on specific instructions for each part. Write the correct question number in your answer sheet to indicate the option/s being attempted.**

SECTION A: READING SKILLS (22 Marks)

Q1. Read the passage given below and answer the questions that follow. (12 M)

The intricate tapestry of human evolution is woven with the threads of two enigmatic species: the Neanderthals and Homo sapiens. Their coexistence, although separated by vast epochs of time, offers a glimpse into the diverse mosaic of our ancient past.

Neanderthals, denizens of the Pleistocene epoch, roamed the rugged landscapes of Europe and parts of Asia during the frigid grip of the last Ice Age. Their robust physiques, marked by pronounced brow ridges and powerful musculature, epitomized adaptation to harsh environments. Contrasting with their Homo sapiens counterparts, Neanderthals crafted tools from raw materials with a finesse that echoed their mastery of survival in the wild.

In stark contrast, Homo sapiens, emerging from the crucible of Africa's savannahs, heralded a new era of bravery, skill, and innovation. Their anatomically modern features, characterized by a high forehead and a pronounced chin, foreshadowed the dawn of civilization. Armed with a cognitive toolkit unmatched in the annals of prehistory, Homo sapiens

forged ahead, fashioning intricate tools, fostering complex social structures, and leaving indelible marks on the canvas of human history.

Despite their disparate trajectories, Neanderthals, and Homo sapiens shared common ground. Both species possessed an innate curiosity that spurred technological innovation and artistic expression. Archaeological sites reveal a rich tapestry of symbolic artefacts, hinting at shared cultural practices and rituals that transcended geographical boundaries.

Yet, beneath the veneer of similarity lurked the spectre of difference. Neanderthals, with their brawny physique and stocky frame, thrived in the crucible of the Ice Age, a testament to their resilience in the face of adversity. Homo sapiens, conversely, embarked on a journey of exploration and expansion, traversing continents and conquering new frontiers with an insatiable thirst for knowledge and conquest.

The enigma of Neanderthal extinction, shrouded in the mists of time, continues to elude definitive explanation. Some scholars put forward the spectre of environmental pressures, while others point to the inexorable march of Homo sapiens, whose ascendancy spelled doom for their archaic cousins.

In the labyrinthine corridors of prehistory, Neanderthals and Homo sapiens stand as guardians of a bygone era whose echoes reverberate across the sands of time.

Now based on your reading answer the following questions.

1. Which of the following physical characteristics is characteristic of Neanderthals? (1)

- a) High forehead.
- b) Pronounced chin.
- c) Robust physique.
- d) Large brain size

2. What is one significant cultural similarity between Neanderthals and Homo sapiens? (1)

- a) Mastery of fire.

b) Development of agriculture.

c) Creation of art

d) Establishment of complex political systems

3. What evidence suggests cultural exchange between Neanderthals and Homo sapiens during prehistoric times? (2)

4. What are the primary hypotheses regarding the demise of the Neanderthals, and how do they differ in their explanations? (2)

5. Complete the sentence with a word or a phrase:

Neanderthals were well-adapted to the rigors of the Ice Age, demonstrating remarkable _____ in the face of environmental challenges. (1)

6. How do Neanderthals and Homo sapiens differ in terms of their physical morphology and adaptation strategies? (2)

7. Where did both Neanderthals and Homo sapiens likely originate, with reference to the _____ passage? Choose from the options: (1)

a) Neanderthals originated in Europe, while Homo sapiens originated in Asia.

b) Both Neanderthals and Homo sapiens originated in Africa, but Neanderthals later migrated to Europe and parts of Asia.

c) Neanderthals originated in Africa, while Homo sapiens originated in Europe.

d) Neanderthals originated in Asia, while Homo sapiens originated in Africa.

8. Complete the sentence:

The phrases "the mists of time" and "the labyrinthine corridors of prehistory" hint that our knowledge of ancient history _____. (1)

9. Which of the following terms best describes Homo sapiens' expansion across different continents? Choose from the options: (1)

a) Extermination

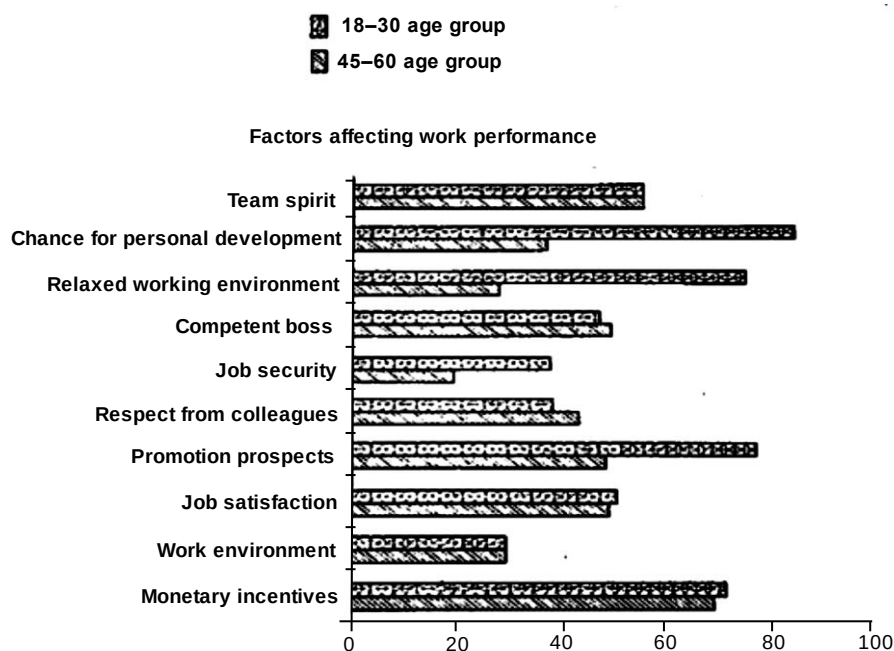
b) Colonization

c) Subjugation

(d) Isolation

Q2: Read the following passage and answer the questions that follow. **10M**

1. Nowadays companies demand an outstanding job performance by every single employee to be better than that of their competitors because there is competition among enterprises. The employers make efforts to motivate the employees and optimize performance.
2. There are numerous factors affecting job performance. These can be divided into external and internal factors. The internal factors are team spirit, competent boss, respect from colleagues and job satisfaction. The external factors are chance for personal development, job security, promotion prospects and monetary incentives. The decisive determinant is that the employees remain highly motivated. One possible method to increase motivation is the salary. Employees are willing to stay longer hours in the office and perform better, when they have the chance to get financial rewards, for instance, a higher salary or bonuses.



3. The bar graph (given below) shows the result of a survey conducted among workers in a company to analyse their work performance across ten

different factors that contribute to make their work environment pleasant. The workers are grouped into two categories those between the ages of 18-30 and those between 45- 60. Interestingly, in six out of the ten factors surveyed, the 18 30 age group is shown to be more affected than the 45-60 age group. Factors, besides the salary, which affect the work performance of the two different age groups are interesting. These factors are the chance for personal development, relaxed working environment, promotion prospects, job satisfaction and monetary incentives. Furthermore, two out of the remaining four factors namely, team spirit and work environment have been equally influential among the two groups. The 45- 60 years workers are impacted a lot by 'respect from colleagues' whereas the prospect of promotion is an important reason that drives younger employees to work better.

4. Job performance of happy employees is 31% more productive and they show three times more creativity than their unhappy counterparts. They are more resilient and more likely to stay in the same company for a longer period. Consequently, they drive the company towards long-term goals by being more productive and efficient.

Based on your understanding of the passage, answer the questions given below: **10*1=10**

(a) Does the following statement agree with the information given in para 1? **(1)**

When the company has a lot of competitors, it tries to invent the most efficient technology to stay ahead.

Select from the following:

True: If the statement agrees with the information.

False: If the statement contradicts the information.

Not Given: If there is no information on this

(b) Why do you think the companies demand exemplary performance from their employees? Support your answer with reference to the passage. **(2)**

(c) Select the option that displays the most likely reason for employees to perform better. **(1)**

- (i) Companies demand an outstanding performance
- (ii) If the company grows, their growth is assured
- (iii) When there are chances to get financial gratification
- (iv) To drive the company towards long-term goals

(d) Based on the bar graph, complete the following statement: (1)

The 18- 30 age group is shown to be more affected than the 45- 60 age group in most factors.

We can say this because _____ .

(e) Complete the given sentence by selecting the most appropriate option. (1)

Loyalty as an attribute is there in employees who are _____

- (a) senior
- (b) healthy
- (c) motivated
- (d) happy

(f) Based on the reading of the passage, state a point to challenge the given statement. (2)

Increase in salary is the only motivation for better job performance.

(g) Find the synonym of the word 'equivalents' from para 4. (1)

(h) Complete the given sentence by selecting the most appropriate option: (1)

The concluding sentence of the passage makes a clear case for _____ by listing it as a core component of steering the company towards long-term goals.

- (a) collaboration
- (b) flexibility
- (c) happiness
- (d) adaptability

SECTION B: CREATIVE WRITING SKILLS (18 marks)

Q.3 (A) Social Science Club of your school has invited the Inspector of Police (Traffic) to deliver a lecture on 'Road Safety' in the school. Draft a notice, in about 50 words informing the students to assemble in school auditorium. You are Ronit/ Raksha, Head boy/girl. (4M)

Or

(B) Under the banner of the Local Sanitary Services, your school is organizing a Health & Hygiene Camp with an emphasis on 'Clean living and Healthy eating' for the benefits of students between age of 13 years to 17 years. Draft a notice, informing students of the event. You are Amrit /Anita, Secretary, Swachhta Sena.

Q.4 (A) You are Mr. Gogoi, an eminent Scientist who has been invited to address the students of Wisdom Public School on 'Generating Scientific Aptitude in Students'. Draft a formal reply in 50 words expressing your inability to attend the function. (4M)

Or

(B) You are Samay/ Aruna of F-201, GT road, Chandigarh. You have just purchased a new house. You decided to have a house-warming ceremony and invite your cousin Priya. Write the invitation in 50 words giving all necessary details.

Q.5 (A) You are Raman/Reema, residing at 21, Sunshine Apartment, Chennai. You came across the following advertisement in a national newspaper and wish to apply for the position advertised. Write an application along with your resume, expressing your interest in the advertised post. (5M)

Ranco Chemical Industries Mumbai

WANTED

ACCOUNTS OFFICER

To manage accounts

Only Experienced Hands

Skills : Maintaining books of accounts,
preparation of balance sheets, etc.

Please send your resume to Managing
Director, RCI, B-12, Pedder Road, Mumbai

Or

(B) You are Mayank/ Riya, a resident of Gwalior. You feel students should use the internet mostly for gaining knowledge rather than wasting time merely on entertainment. Write a letter in about 120-150 words to the Editor of The Times of India pointing out how schools can control students net surfing at school and enable them to use the Internet fruitfully.

Q.6 (A) India is an emerging economy. We are rich in natural resources. Yet a significant proportion of our people are living below poverty line. One cause of this poverty is our rising population. Write an article, in 120-150 words, on 'How to keep a Check on Population'. You are Karuna/karuna.

(5M)

Or

(B). Traffic police has launched a special drive against pollution –causing vehicles. This has led to traffic jams and crowds at important intersections. Write a report, in 120-150 words, to be published in 'Indian Times'. You are Prakash/Priya, 14 M.G. Road, Delhi.

SECTION C: LITERATURE (40 Marks)

Q.7 (A) Read the Extract and answer the questions that follow:

6x1=6M

Sometimes I feel myself I can hardly bear
The thought of so much childish longing in vain,
The sadness that lurks near the open window there,
That waits all day in almost open prayer.
For the squeal of brakes, the sound of a stopping car,
Of all the thousand selfish cars that pass,
Just one to inquire what a farmer's prices are,

(a) Which sentiments are being expressed in the above extract?

- (1) remorse
- (2) regret
- (3) empath
- (4) disappointment
- (5) guilt

Choose the correct appropriate option.

- (i) (3) and (4)
- (ii) (2) and (3)
- (iii) (4) and (5)
- (iv) (1) and (5)

(b) Identify the phrase in the stanza that suggests 'innocent desires'.

(c) The roadside stand owners pray for:

- (i) a relief from the heat
- (ii) free housing
- (iii) cars stopping
- (iv) benefits from pollution

(d) Complete the following analogy correctly:

He fought like a lion: Simile:: selfish cars: _____

(e) On the basis of the extract, choose the correct option with reference to Statement (1) and (2) given below:

(1) The people who have put up the roadside stand keep waiting for customers.

(2) They become sad when someone turns up.

- (i) (1) is true, but (2) is false.
- (ii) (1) is false, but (2) is true
- (iii) Both (1) and (2) are true.
- (iv) Both (1) and (2) are false

(f) Complete the following.

'Squeal of brakes' implies _____

Or

(B) Perhaps the Earth can teach us

As when everything seems dead

And later proves to be alive

Now I will count up to twelve

And you keep quiet and I will go.

1. Pick out the option that is not correct with reference to the poem.

A. Silence teaches us to live in harmony.

B. By remaining silent, we can spread peace and be productive at the same time.

C. The Earth nurtures life and ensures that the cycle of life goes on unhampered.

D. The poet appeals to be chaotic and create noises and have fun.

2. Which poetic device has been used by the poet in the line "Perhaps the Earth can teach us"?

A. Metaphor

B. Alliteration

C. Personification

D. Antithesis

3. The poem discusses the need of ----

A. having conversation with each other.

B. maintaining peace and silence.

C. maintaining social relations.

D. fulfilling the generation gap.

4. Complete the sentence appropriately.

The whole humanity needs to learn a lesson to _____ and understand each other.

5. According to the poet, what can we learn from the earth?

6. In the above extract, the poet wants us to learn lesson from _____.

Q.8 (A) Read the Paragraph given below and answer the questions that follow: **1x4= 4M**

The tunnel turned sharp left; I went down a short flight of stairs and came out on the third level at Grand Central Station. For just a moment, I thought I was back on the second level, but I saw the room was smaller, there were fewer ticket windows and train gates, and the information booth in the centre was wood and old looking. And the man in the booth wore a green eyeshade and long black sleeve protectors. The lights were dim and sort of flickering. Then I saw why; they were open-flame gaslights.

(a) Where did Charley reach?

(b) How did Charley realise that he was on the third level?

- (i) Room was smaller.
- (ii) The information booth was old looking.
- (iii) There were fewer ticket windows and train gates.
- (iv) All of these

(c) Why the lights were dim on the platform?

(d) Which word from the following means the same as 'lambent'?

- (i) Gaslights
- (ii) Flickering
- (iii) Eyeshade
- (iv) Dim

Or

"There is something about him that looks American," Dr Sadao said. He took up the battered cap. Yes, there, almost gone, was the faint lettering. "A

sailor," he said, "from an American warship." He spelled it out: "U.S. Navy." The man was a prisoner of war! "He has escaped." Hana cried softly, "and that is why he is wounded. "In the back," Dr Sadao agreed.

(a) Who took the battered cap?

- (i) Dr Sadao
- (ii) White man
- (iii) Author
- (iv) Yumi

(b) The man was a prisoner of war. (True/False)

(c) What was written on the battered cap?

(d) Why did Hana say, "he has escaped"?

- (i) Because he was wounded in the back
- (ii) Because he was a prisoner of war
- (iii) Because he was a sailor
- (iv) Both (i) and (ii)

Q9. Read the paragraph carefully and answer the question that follows:

6x1=6M

"I sometimes find a rupee, even a ten rupee note", Saheb says, his eyes lighting up when you can find a silver coin in a heap of garbage, you don't stop scrounging, for there is hope of finding more. It seems that for children, garbage has a meaning different from what it means to their parents. For the children it is wrapped in wonder, for the elders it is a means of survival.

One winter morning I see Saheb standing by the fenced gate of the neighbourhood club, watching two young men dressed in white, playing tennis. "I like the game", he hums, content to watch it standing behind the fence. "I go inside when no one is around" he admits. "The gate keeper lets me use the swing."

(a) Saheb found a rupee:

- (i) on the street
- (ii) in the garbage dump
- (iii) in Firozabad
- (iv) on the tennis court

(b) Which emotion of Saheb is revealed in the phrase 'his eyes lighting up'?

- (i) Anxiety
- (ii) Envy
- (iii) Happiness
- iv) Greed

(c) Identify the literary device in the line “For the children it is wrapped in wonder, for the elders it is a means of survival.”

- (i) Hyperbole
- (ii) Simile
- (iii) Contrast
- (iv) Personification

(d) On the basis of the extract, choose the correct option with reference to I and II statement given below:

- I. Saheb watches the game from outside.
- II. Saheb had lost the previous match.

- (i) I is true but II is not
- (ii) II is true but I is not
- (iii) Both I and II are true
- (iv) Both I and II are untrue

(e) 'Scrounging' in the passage most nearly means:

- (i) digging
- (ii) searching
- (iii) flinging

(iv) burying

(f) "There is hope for finding more'. Explain with reference to the given extract.

Or

(B) He had naturally been thinking of his rattraps when suddenly he was struck by the idea that the whole world about him- the whole world with its land and seas, its cities and villages - was nothing but a big rattrap. It had never existed for any other purpose than to set baits for people.

(a) Who is 'he' referred to here?

(b) What was he thinking?

(i) About rattraps

(ii) About his survival

(iii) About cities and villages

(iv) None of these

(c) According to him, what is the purpose of the world?

(i) To kill people

(ii) To set baits for people

(iii) To spread kindness

(iv) To hypnotise world

(d) Which word from the following means the same as 'allurement'?

(i) Struck

(ii) Rattrap

(iii) Idea

(iv) Bait

(e) What does the 'rattrap' symbolise?

(f) Fill in the blank.

The literary device used by the author to signify the rattrap is____

Q.10 Answer the following questions (Any Five) in about 40-50 words each. (5x2=10M)

1. How did Franz's feelings about M. Hamel and school change? (The Last Lesson)
2. Why do you think Aunt Jennifer created tigers that are so different from her own character? Give reasons suggested by the poet.
3. Describe the challenges or fears that the author faced in learning to swim. How did he overcome it? (Deep Water)
4. In one's approach to life one should be practical and not live in a world of dreams. How is Jainsie's attitude different that of Sophie?
5. What do the parting words of the poet and her smile signify in the poem "My Mother at Sixty-Six"?
6. Why was the office boy frustrated? Whom did he show his anger on? (Poets and pancakes)

Q.11 Answer the following questions in about 40-50 words each. (Any two) (2x2=4M)

1. The manner of the Tiger King's death is a matter of extraordinary interest. Comment.
2. How is Antarctica a crucial element in the debate of climate change?
3. How do we know that Dr. Sadao was conscientious as well as loyal?

Q.12 Answer Any One of the following in about 120-150 words. (5x1=5M)

1. Describe the events which led to change in the peddler's way of life? (The Rattrap)

Or

2. If Gandhi had focused only on the immediate issue of the indigo farmers in the chapter "Indigo", how might the long-term impact on Champaran have differed?

Q.13 Answer Any One of the following in about 120-150 words.

(5x1=5M)

1. Tom, the POW reaches home safe. He feels blessed and is very grateful to Dr Sadao and his wife for their thoughtfulness, dedication and being compassionate throughout the treatment and till he's sent back home. After reaching home, he writes his thoughts reflecting on how being an enemy Dr Sadao and his wife Hana prove that "The greatness of humanity is not in being human, but in being humane." Imagine yourself as Tom and express these thoughts. You may start with....

Wednesday xx December xxxx 10.30 p.m.

Dear Diary

May God bless Dr Sadao and his family-the angels in human disguise with long life! I owe my life -----

Or

2. How has human civilization impacted our environment? Comment with reference to the lesson 'journey to the End of the Earth'.